WATCH

ANNIVERSARY

Marine Tourbillon Équation Marchante 5887: The night sky, bottled

If the 7357 is Breguet murmuring, the Marine Tourbillon Équation Marchante 5887 is Breguet bellowing across a crowded ballroom, and somehow pulling it off. This is the most complicated wristwatch in the brand's current catalogue, a 43.9mm platinum heavyweight that marries a tourbillon to a perpetual calendar and a running equation of time, the last being that wonderfully impractical complication which tells you the gap between the hour on your watch and the hour the sun believes it to be. Any of that alone would justify the watch. Then there is the dial. Beneath a sheet of tinted sapphire lies a hand-painted miniature in luminous Grand Feu enamel showing the precise night sky above Paris at midnight on 26 June 1801, the very evening Breguet secured his patent. In darkness the whole thing glows, constellations and moon included, while the equation-of-time hand appears to levitate on an invisible sapphire arm tipped with a minuscule golden sun. And should the heavens over revolutionary Paris feel insufficiently personal, Breguet will paint the sky of your own chosen date and place instead: a birth, a wedding, an especially memorable dinner. Limited to 25 pieces and offered on a strap or a wrist-flattening platinum bracelet, it is lavish, theatrical and entirely without apology. Which, on this of all anniversaries, feels exactly right.

